

Patryk Popenda

Applied LLM / AI Engineer · Remote EU · based in Poland

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SUMMARY

Applied-LLM engineer shipping two production Polish-language SaaS products built on the Anthropic API + AWS Bedrock. Comfortable across the full LLM stack: prompt engineering, forced tool-use with strict JSON schemas, multi-modal (text + vision) routing, prompt caching, evaluation, schema-validated output, cost modelling, and security auditing of LLM output boundaries (prompt injection, delimiter spoofing, stored XSS). Solo founder by necessity — I own the model layer, the FastAPI service, the worker, the Postgres schema, the Stripe integration, and the prod VM. Background is Windows + PowerShell systems engineering inside a large industrial-automation org, so I'm equally at home in M365 / Entra ID / Intune ops as I am in Linux + Docker. Looking for a remote-EU role where the LLM layer is genuinely load-bearing, not a wrapper.

SELECTED PRODUCTION WORK

Faktomat — Polish invoice IDP SaaS

2025 – 2026 · solo

Live at faktomat.ewwesolutions.work

Paying flow end-to-end: signup → email verification → Stripe top-up → PDF upload → LLM extraction → editable review → JPK_FA (Polish government) XML export. Charged at 0.50 PLN per processed invoice.

- **Bedrock Claude (Haiku) extraction pipeline with forced tool-use** — `tool_choice={"type": "tool", "name": ...}` + strict pydantic `TOOL_SCHEMA`, which eliminates the "model emits text outside the schema" failure mode entirely. Schema violations become server errors, not silent drops.
- **Multi-modal routing.** Text path uses pdfplumber/pypdf; if text extraction is degenerate, the same chunk is re-sent as a `document` block (rasterised pages) — vision-mode fallback at parity cost per the published Anthropic pricing.
- **Bounded blast-radius extraction.** Per-page cost ceiling, per-upload spend cap, friendly Polish error messages with raw LLM output preserved to `audit_events.payload.error_raw` for post-hoc debugging.
- **Stack:** FastAPI · pydantic-strict · SQLAlchemy + Alembic · arq worker · Postgres · Redis · MinIO (S3-compatible) · Stripe live (Checkout Sessions + webhooks) · Cloudflared tunnel · all containerised via docker-compose on a Hyper-V Ubuntu VM.
- **Discipline:** mypy `--strict` across the source tree, integration test suite that hits a real Postgres (no mocks at the DB boundary), pre-push secret-audit script, public `/status` page (DB / Redis / MinIO probes + 30 s cache + bounded boto3 timeouts), per-event Discord alerter with anchored cursor.

Fiszkomat — Polish PDF → Anki flashcard generator

2025 – 2026 · solo

Live at fiszkomat.ewwesolutions.work

Paid checkout, in-browser SM-style reviewer + `.apkg` export, 7 curated sample decks (296 cards) on the landing page.

- **Direct Anthropic API** (Claude Haiku 4.5) with **prompt caching** (`cache_control: ephemeral`) on the system prompt — meaningful per-run cost reduction since the system prompt is the chunked-call prefix.
- **Pydantic-validated card schema** (`z, t, d, m, i, c, n`) with sha1 dedup, length caps per field, and a Polish-only enforcement detector that inspects every visible card text field against an English-only stopword set chosen to avoid Polish false positives. Iterated from 5 hard-coded stopwords to a curated 47-word set after a static audit.
- **268-line static prompt-safety audit** I wrote against my own code (`docs/fiszkomat-prompt-audit.md`) covering: delimiter-spoof injection via `---` chunk markers, Polish-only detector gaps, HTML-escape posture across three render surfaces (server-side sample HTML, in-browser reviewer DOM, Anki Mustache template), DoS surface paywalling, prompt caching as economic optimisation vs security control.
- **XSS regression tests as positive pins** on the LLM output path — if a future refactor swaps `html.escape` for raw interpolation or switches the reviewer from `textContent` to `innerHTML` , the test suite fails loudly with a comment pointing to the audit.
- **147 pytest tests** covering `validate_cards`, telemetry sanitisation (no `$X.XX` cost or token counts leak to `/status`), sample-deck asset integrity, and the audit findings.
- **Active dogfood user** giving structured feedback (a Polish medical student preparing for kolokwia).

Studio — ewwesolutions.work

2025 – 2026

Umbrella site for both products. Static HTML served by a tiny systemd unit; the equity card pulls live paper-trading P&L from a 30-minute Alpaca snapshot timer. Honest delta-from-baseline rendering — no cherry-picked highs.

CORE STACK

- **LLM:** Anthropic Claude (direct API + AWS Bedrock), prompt caching, forced tool-use with input schemas, vision/document blocks, structured output validation, multi-modal routing, cost modelling, prompt-injection threat-modelling, evaluation against real Polish-language inputs.
- **Backend:** Python 3.12, FastAPI, Pydantic (strict), SQLAlchemy + Alembic, asyncio, arq (Redis-backed task queue).
- **Data:** Postgres, Redis, MinIO (S3-compatible), boto3.
- **Infra (Linux):** Docker, docker-compose, Cloudflared, systemd, Ubuntu.
- **Infra (Windows):** Hyper-V, PowerShell (Exchange Online, MSGraph / AzureAD, Intune Graph API, ActiveDirectory module), Group Policy, Intune configuration profiles, Entra ID conditional access.
- **Payments:** Stripe (Checkout Sessions, live keys, webhook verification, idempotency).
- **Frontend:** Server-rendered Jinja2 + vanilla JS, minimal-dep philosophy, no SPA framework.
- **Discipline:** `mypy --strict` , `pytest` (unit + integration), pre-push secret audit, conventional commits, post-hoc rationale in CHANGELOG.

LANGUAGES

Polish **English**

native fluent — technical writing, async, on-call

PREVIOUS EXPERIENCE

Rockwell Automation — IT Specialist (L2 / L3)

2022 – 2024

Enterprise systems engineering inside a large industrial-automation org. Tier-2/3 owner for Windows endpoint, Active Directory / Entra ID identity, and the Microsoft 365 stack — primarily a PowerShell-driven role, with ServiceNow as the system of record.

- **PowerShell as the primary tool.** Day-to-day work was scripted, not clicked: Exchange Online Management cmdlets for mailbox / mail-flow / transport-rule tasks, MSGraph / AzureAD modules for Entra ID identity and conditional access, Intune Graph API for device-config drift, ActiveDirectory module for on-prem AD. Recurring fixes became runnable `.ps1` scripts rather than KB walkthroughs — the next occurrence was a one-line invocation, not a fresh investigation.
- **Windows 10/11 endpoint engineering.** Group Policy + Intune configuration profiles, Windows update rings, BitLocker recovery, always-on VPN profiles, conditional-access edge cases, Autopilot enrolment failures, profile / OneDrive corruption recovery. Comfortable below the GUI — Event Viewer, `gpresult`, `dsregcmd`, `Test-NetConnection`, Sysinternals — and at home reading a Windows event log instead of guessing.
- **Microsoft 365 L2/L3 at scale.** Exchange Online (transport rules, message tracing, hybrid quirks), Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive — admin centre and the underlying Graph/PowerShell surface. Worked Intune-managed device drift back to a known-good baseline.
- **Direct end-user resolution over the queue handoff.** Defaulted to connecting straight to the affected user — remote session, call, or walk-up — to close the ticket in one pass rather than ping-pong it through assignment groups. Faster SLA closure, fewer reopens, higher user-side trust.
- **Change-approval gate for offshore ops.** Reviewed and signed off on production-VM restarts, maintenance windows, and infra changes executed by the outsourced ops vendor — the "I approve, proceed" reply that gates a prod-touching action.
- **Runbook + knowledge-base authoring.** Documented recurring fixes — and the PowerShell snippets that resolved them — in the ServiceNow KB so L1 could deflect the same ticket without another escalation.
- **Cross-timezone async written communication.** Most of the work was email and ticket comments to teams in IST and US-CT — the exact written-async muscle the LLM/SaaS work later leaned on.

EDUCATION

- **Self-taught software engineer.** Python, FastAPI, Anthropic API, AWS, Stripe, Docker, Postgres — all production-grade and shipping real revenue. Everything in *Selected production work* above was built outside any formal CS program.

LINKS

- Studio (umbrella): ewwesolutions.work
- Faktomat (live): faktomat.ewwesolutions.work
- Fiszkomat (live, sample decks browsable without payment): fiszkomat.ewwesolutions.work
- Code monorepo: github.com/ewwe72/ewwesolutions
- LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/patryk-popenda